Township of NIPISSING
"Life the way it should be" ESTABLISHED 1888

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REPORT TO COUNCIL

Date: September 23, 2024

From: Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator

Re: Landfill Proposal – Service Updates Follow up

Recommendation:

That the Township of Nipissing Council receives this report for action.

Purpose:
Staff have been reviewing possible landfill service updates for the following priorities:

1. Waste reduction strategies.
2. Improved working experience for staff including health and safety requirements.
3. Improved efficiencies for record keeping and monitoring of landfill.

Background Information:

Waste Reduction Strategies:

Bag Limits have been investigated.

Based on the number of properties in the Township of Nipissing and using a base number of 110 bags per year/per household compared to the actual number of bags deposited in both Township landfills in 2023, it appears that most households in the Township are using well below the 2 bag limit suggested.

This program would have little to no effect on the number of bags being deposited at the Landfill sites as residents are currently reducing waste at an above expected rate.

The results of the Community Survey show a strong support for bag limits. This strategy may be considered moving forward.

Recommendation:

2025 Landfill Entry Permits be procured with sequential numbering, per current practice.

2026 Landfill Entry Permits be provided with a bag count system incorporated. This will not limit the bag numbers but will assist with the monitoring and count of incoming waste to provide data input to consider in future decisions. A procedure will be created and presented to Council in 2025 for launch of the 2026 card on April 1, 2024.

Improvements to Working Experience:

Administration and staff have been discussing options to improve the working experience at each landfill site.
Currently the sites are open 4 full days of 8 hours each and 2 half days of 4 hours each. This results in a 6-day work week for staff.

Opening the landfill sites from 9 am until 7 pm on Friday, Saturday, Sunday and Monday, provides an open site at each location for a total of 20 hours per week, the same number of hours open and operational currently.

The elimination of the 4 hour days will help staff save costs of attending to work on a short day as well as providing them a predictable three-day break period.

Staff were consulted on this option prior to suggesting it to Council and are in agreement.

The results of the Community Survey show a strong support for the schedule change with one change. Those using the Wolfe Lake Landfill brought forward that the site is closed more frequently on statutory holidays falling on Mondays, disrupting their service levels. It was recommended that the Wolfe Lake Landfill be open Thursdays 7 a.m. to 9 p.m. and Saturdays 7 a.m. to 9 p.m. with Bear Creek Landfill open Fridays 7 a.m. to 9 p.m. and Sundays 7 a.m. to 9 p.m.

Recommendation:

Follow the public recommendation and apply for the operating hour change to:

Wolfe Lake Landfill Thursday and Saturday from ~~7:00 a.m. to 9:00 p.m.~~ 9:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m.

Bear Creek Landfill Friday and Sunday from ~~7:00 a.m. to 9:00 p.m.~~ 9:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m.

Change to take effect on January 1, 2025 to allow for signage updates and education information to be circulated to the residents.

Improved operational efficiencies:

Moving from a paper landfill entry permit system to a swipe card system was investigated.

Costing of Moneris system with cards and debit implementation came to an estimated start up cost of $6,500. This system and the required maintenance and monthly fees are not a fiscally responsible option for the landfill use.

At this time, staff recommends the utilization of a punch card system issued to each landowner. This will require the presentation of the card at the landfill with each use and allow us to monitor the number of bags being deposited at the landfill in a more efficient manner without imposing a bag limit, only monitoring the number of bags brought in.

Recommendation:

Continue to investigate an electronic method of monitoring while utilizing the punch card system to be implemented in 2026.

Waste Diversion/Waste Reduction Program Updates:

Locations have been designated for compost areas at each landfill. These will require some dedicated funds to develop and a plan created for the operation.

Community survey results received to date indicate approximately half of the respondents are interested in this program. The interest indicates something to be investigated further for use.

Recommendation:

With a lack of interest in the program, methods continue to be investigated for future implementation if required.

Respectfully,

Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator

Waste Management

DO YOU AGREE WITH 10 HOUR DAYS?



WOULD YOU USE AN ORGANICS SITE?

